Lesson 25: Unit 2 Review: Editing, Writing and a Presentation

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 2: Sentences and Paragraph Types · American History

Adapted from High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0): 7.1: Exercise 12-Editing; 7.2: Exercise 13-Writing; 7.3: Exercise 14-Presentation; Rubrics.

In this lesson

You will review the three grammar points of Unit 2 (modals, adjective clauses and passive voice) by editing a student's summary about voting rights in the U.S., writing two paragraphs about an event or policy in American history, and giving an 8- to 10-minute recorded presentation on the same topic to your tutor. Editing for these forms and explaining causes and consequences are key skills for college papers and talks.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Find and correct errors with modals, adjective clauses and passive voice in an academic paragraph.
- Name the type of each error and the rule behind the correction.
- Write two paragraphs about a historical event or policy: what led to it, its consequences and the people involved.
- Give a prepared and rehearsed presentation on the same topic.
- Score your writing and your presentation with the book's rubrics.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning	Example
modal (MO·dal)	a helping verb (can, could, may, might, should, will, would, must) used before a base verb (the verb with no to, -s, -ed or -ing)	We must be on time for class.
adjective clause	a dependent clause (with a subject and a verb, but not a full sentence) that describes a noun	The girl who is sitting in the front is new.
relative pronoun (REL·a·tive)	the word that begins an adjective clause: who, whom, which, that, whose, when, where	The woman whom you met at the party likes square dancing.
passive voice (PAS·sive)	receiver + be + past participle (+ by + performer)	The student was tutored by Patty.

Word or phrase	Meaning	Example
eligible (EL·i·gi·ble), eligibility	having the right to do something, for example to vote	The state governments establish voter eligibility.
enact (en·ACT)	make a law official	Many states enacted poll taxes.
poll tax, literacy test (LIT·er·a·cy)	a fee people had to pay before they could vote; a reading and writing test people had to pass before they could vote	poll taxes, literacy tests, or grandfather clauses
grandfather clause	a rule that excused a man from these taxes and tests if his grandfather could vote; in practice it helped only white men	
felony (FEL·o·ny), felon (FEL·on)	a serious crime; a person found guilty of one	felon disenfranchisement
disenfranchisement (dis·en·FRAN·chise·ment)	taking away a person's right to vote	Another approach to voter ineligibility is felon disenfranchisement.
incarcerated (in·CAR·cer·at·ed)	in prison or jail	only while the person is incarcerated

Rules and explanations

What to look for when you edit

The book's rules from Lessons 16 (Modals), 19 (Adjective Clauses) and 23 (Passive Voice):

Point	Rule	Errors to look for
Modals	subject + modal + base verb. Choose the meaning: should = advice or obligation; must = strong necessity or a strong guess (95%); may, might, could = possibility (less than 50%); can = ability or possibility.	"I can to move", "I could moving", "He must drives", two modals ("I should must renew"), a missing modal
Adjective clauses	who = people (subject, followed by a verb); whom = people (object, followed by a subject + verb); which = specific things, used with commas; that = general things or people, no commas; whose = possession; when = time; where = place. A restrictive clause (needed to identify the noun) has no commas; a non-restrictive clause (extra information) has commas.	the verb does not agree with the noun; a repeated subject or object ("The book that I bought it"); the clause is far from its noun
Passive voice	receiver + be + past participle (+ by + performer). The be verb shows the tense and agrees with the subject: is/are tutored, was/were tutored, has/have been tutored, will be tutored. Only verbs with an object can be passive.	a missing be verb; be not agreeing with the subject; "be" added to an active verb

You can also shorten a clause with who/which/that + be: "The car that is in my driveway" → "The car in my driveway".

How your work is scored (the book's rubrics)

A rubric is a table that shows how work is scored. Each goal gets Exemplary 4, Satisfactory 3, Approaching Satisfactory 2, or Unsatisfactory/Incomplete 1 or 0 points (20 points in total).

Writing assignment goals	Presentation assignment goals
1. The paragraph includes each of the grammar forms. The grammar forms are underlined and labeled.	1. The presentation includes the unit's grammar, and it is used accurately and appropriately.
2. The grammar forms are accurately and appropriately used.	2. The content of the presentation aligns with (matches) the assignment.
3. The paragraph is well developed and logically written.	3. The presentation tool (your slides) uses appropriate color, images, and font to enhance the content.
4. The paragraph is word processed (typed) and double-spaced.	4. The delivery shows that the student has obviously prepared and rehearsed (practised).
5. It is free from spelling, punctuation, and writing errors including comma splices and run-ons.	5. It is free from spelling, punctuation, and general writing errors.

> **Note for Arabic speakers**
>
> - Arabic uses the same relative word for people and things, so "which" for people and "who" for things are common errors. People: who, whom, that. Things: which, that.
> - Arabic keeps a pronoun inside the relative clause ("the law that they passed it"). In English, the relative pronoun replaces it: "the law that they passed".

Practice

1. Book Exercise 12: Editing. Read the summary paragraph about voters' rights written by a political science student. Identify and correct errors related to modals, adjective clauses, and passive voice. The book asks you to copy the passage into a word processor and track the changes (see the videos in Watch online); you can also write your corrections on the printed copy. Then write the type of each error. Hint: the key lists 13 grammar errors (most of them with these three points) and 4 other errors (capital letters, word choice).

(1) The United States has a long history of creating obstacles for voter registration and voting. (2) The state governments, not the federal government, establish voter eligibility. (3) At first, only white men which are property owners were eligible. (4) As voting laws with the illusion of new rights was passed, more restrictions appeared. (5) For example, when Black men given the right to vote by the 15th amendment, many states who are in the south enacted poll taxes, literacy tests, or grandfather clauses. (6) Another approach to voter ineligibility is felon disenfranchisement which means anyone whom has been convicted of a felon is excluded from voting. (7) In 21 states, voting rights is lost only while the person is incarcerated. (8) Recently, voting restriction laws which require an identification card have been passed. (9) This is prevents millions of Americans from participating in the democratic process. (10) For instance, a person should not have money for the required documents to obtain an

identification card, or a person might has difficulty traveling to an identification office because of a disability, age and health condition, or access to transportation. (11) Voter restrictions could stop. (12) Let people have a voice!

2. Book Exercise 14: Presentation (do it after the Writing task below). Give an 8- to 10-minute presentation on the topic you wrote about. Describe what led to the event or policy, its consequences, and the people involved. Try to use this unit's grammar.

- Outline: introduction; what led to it; the people involved; the consequences; conclusion.
- Make 6-10 simple slides (the rubric scores color, images and font).
- Rehearse twice with a timer, then record yourself with your phone.
- Give the talk to your tutor in Live conversation (or paste a transcript) and ask for a score with the presentation rubric.

Speak with your tutor

- "Here is my corrected version of the voting rights paragraph: [paste]. Compare it with the key in my guide and explain any differences."
- "Here are my two paragraphs with the grammar forms underlined and labeled a, b and c: [paste]. Check each label and score my writing with the writing rubric."
- "I am going to give my presentation on [topic]. Listen, then score it with the presentation rubric, 4 points for each goal, and list my grammar errors."
- "Ask me five audience questions about my topic: why it happened, who was involved and what the consequences were. Correct my passive voice."

Writing task

Book Exercise 13. Write two paragraphs about one of the following topics in American history. Describe what led to the event or policy, its consequences, and the people involved.

Guantanamo Bay Detention Camp; Americans with Disabilities Act; Trail of Tears; (Delano) Grape Strike (Boycott); Tulsa Race Massacre; 19th Amendment (Women's Suffrage); Stonewall Riots; Bracero Program; Dakota Access Pipeline; Salem Witch Trials; Jim Crow Laws; The Immigration Act of 1924; The War on Drugs; Defense of Marriage Act; Chinese Massacre of 1871; East L.A. Walkouts (1968 Student Movement); 1954 Operation Wetback; Flint Water Crisis.

- **Research first:** these topics are not in your lesson material. Read about yours in a reliable source, take notes, and write in your own words.
- **Length and parts:** two paragraphs (about 250-350 words in total), for example 1: what led to it and the people involved; 2: its consequences. Each paragraph needs a topic sentence and a conclusion.
- **Grammar:** include each form at least once. Underline each grammar item and label it with the correct letter each time you use it: **a.** modal, **b.** adjective clause, **c.** passive voice.
- **Format:** type it and double-space it.

Self-editing checklist:

- Every modal is followed by a base verb, and its meaning (advice, necessity, possibility) is the one I want.
- I used who/whom for people and which/that for things, with commas only around non-restrictive clauses.
- I did not repeat a pronoun inside an adjective clause.
- Every passive has be + past participle, and the be verb agrees with its subject and shows the right tense.
- Every grammar item is underlined and labeled a, b or c.
- There are no comma splices or run-ons, and I checked spelling and punctuation.

Paste your draft into the chat and ask your tutor for feedback. Then rewrite it.

Watch online

- How to track changes in Microsoft Word (the book's link): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rznrpH-zQy4
- How to track changes in Google Docs (the book's link): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X7yqViYSr74

Answer key

1. Corrected paragraph. The book has no key for this exercise; these corrections follow the rules in this lesson.

The United States has a long history of creating obstacles for voter registration and voting. The state governments, not the federal government, establish voter eligibility. At first, only white men **who were** property owners were eligible. As voting laws with the illusion of new rights **were passed**, more restrictions appeared. For example, when Black men **were given** the right to vote by the 15th **Amendment**, many states **that are in the South** enacted poll taxes, literacy tests, or grandfather clauses. Another approach to voter ineligibility is felon **disenfranchisement, which** means anyone **who** has been convicted of a **felony** is excluded from voting. In 21 states, voting rights **are lost** only while the person is incarcerated. Recently, voting restriction laws **that** require an identification card have been passed. **This prevents** millions of Americans from participating in the democratic process. For instance, a person **might not have** money for the required documents to obtain an identification card, or a person **might have** difficulty traveling to an identification office because of a disability, age and health condition, or **lack of** access to transportation. Voter restrictions **should stop**. Let people have a voice!

#	Sentence	Error	Correction	Type and rule
1	3	which (are property owners)	who	adjective clause: "which" is for things; use who (or that) for people
2	3	are	were	verb tense in the adjective clause: the time is the past ("At first ... were eligible")
3	4	was passed	were passed	passive voice: the be verb must agree with the plural subject "voting laws"
4	5	Black men given	Black men were given	passive voice: be + past participle; the be verb is missing
5	5	states who are	states that are (or shorter: states in the South)	adjective clause: "who" is only for people; restrictive clause, so "that"
6	6	disenfranchisement which	disenfranchisement, which	adjective clause: a non-restrictive clause with "which" needs a comma
7	6	whom has been	who has been	adjective clause: subject relative pronoun (followed by a verb) = who
8	7	voting rights is lost	voting rights are lost	passive voice: the be verb must agree with the plural subject
9	8	laws which require	laws that require	adjective clause: restrictive (it tells which laws), so "that" with no commas

#	Sentence	Error	Correction	Type and rule
10	9	This is prevents	This prevents	verb form: the sentence is active; "is" + a verb with -s is wrong
11	10	should not have	might not have (or may not have)	modal meaning: this is a possibility, not advice
12	10	might has	might have	modal form: modal + base verb
13	11	could stop	should stop (or must stop; should be stopped)	modal meaning: the writer gives advice or a demand, not a possibility
14	5	amendment	Amendment	capitalization: the name of a specific amendment
15	5	the south	the South	capitalization: the name of a region of the U.S.
16	6	a felon	a felony	word choice: a felon is a person; a felony is the crime
17	10	access to transportation	lack of access to transportation	meaning: difficulty comes from not having access

Correct already (do not change): "is excluded" and "have been passed" (correct passive forms); "has been convicted" (present perfect passive).

2. Presentation. (example answer) An outline on the 19th Amendment (Women's Suffrage), with the grammar labeled: a = modal, b = adjective clause, c = passive voice.

1. Introduction: "The 19th Amendment, which was ratified in 1920 (b, c), gave American women the right to vote."
2. What led to it: "In 1848, women who wanted equal rights (b) met at the Seneca Falls Convention. For more than 70 years after that, women were not allowed (c) to vote in most states."
3. The people involved: "Elizabeth Cady Stanton and Susan B. Anthony, whose work lasted for decades (b), led the movement. Alice Paul was arrested (c) in 1917 for protesting outside the White House."
4. The consequences: "Women could vote (a) in every state. However, many Black women in the South could not vote (a) because of poll taxes and literacy tests."
5. Conclusion: "We should remember (a) that rights must be protected (a, c)."

My notes